

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

Usually there is a good rationalization for overwork. It may be to secure the family's future or it may be because "I want my family to have the best." Often the husband will place blame on his wife because, he says, "She just couldn't get along on any less." The truth, most often, is just the opposite. Most wives would be willing to make any sacrifice to have their husbands as companions again.

But as a workaholic husband plows his life deeper and deeper into a job or business, he soon receives most of his satisfaction from work. Why? Because when he comes home he is met by a bitter, frustrated woman.

Because of her frustration, often a woman finds herself becoming snappy and irritable. These attitudes manifest themselves in a variety of ways. Arguments start over trivial matters such as the husband being late for supper or forgetting an anniversary. In a marriage with balance, these are a source of family jokes, not warfare. A wife may go on periodic spending sprees to punish her husband or get his attention. Some other symptoms of frustration are: unpredictable outbursts, threats of divorce, imagined illnesses, alcoholism, or a total dedication to outside interests.

Randy and Julie met when she responded to an ad he placed for an executive secretary. He hired her immediately when he recognized that not only was she a top-notch secretary, but a Christian as well. Randy grew up as a pastor's kid and thought himself to be a Christian. He was honest, ethical and hard-working. Boy, was he *ever* hardworking.

He had built his advertising agency from nothing into a very successful, 7 days-a-week, 14 hours-a-day business.

That didn't bother Julie. She was single, intelligent, and a totally dedicated high "S," supporter. Randy was the typical high "D," creative person who had little or no balance when it came to work.

They worked side by side for a year, realized they were in love and, as lovers will do, got married. They still worked together with no conflicts of any kind until Julie got pregnant. Then Julie couldn't keep up the pace and found herself at home